



GREY BANNER ALERT



SHW Serious Incident (SI) – Final Notice

Date of Incident	4 th February 2024	Time of Incident	7.35am
Directorate / Region	RMO – Midwest Gascoyne	Main Roads or Contractor	Contractor
EQSafe Event Type	Near Miss - Injury	EQSafe Incident Number	37443
Actual Consequence	Insignificant	Potential Consequence	Major

Incident Short Description	Follow Me Vehicle attempted U-turn in front of road train
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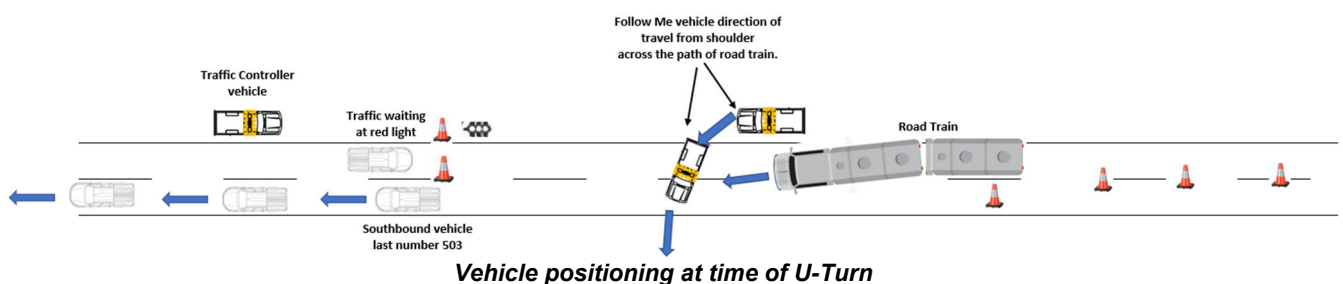
Executive Summary

On Sunday 4 February at approximately 7.35am, a traffic control (TC) Follow Me vehicle was escorting traffic southbound on Brand Highway. The TC at the northern lights called that "503 would be the last" then moments later added on "road train will be your last".

The Follow Me vehicle escorted the queued traffic southbound, and then pulled onto the right traffic shoulder to let the traffic pass. The driver then saw vehicle 503 pass and had then attempted to conduct a U-turn from the shoulder. The driver did not see the road train that had been added on, as the view from the passenger side mirror was obscured by sun glare.

Queued traffic at the south end sounded their horn, alerting the driver of the road train. The driver then looked around and saw the road train approaching, accelerating out of the way, off the road and down the shoulder.

Traffic was held and the driver of the Follow Me vehicle was swapped out. The incident was communicated to all traffic controllers, and it was mandated that no U-turns are to occur without all clear from traffic controllers.



Incident Photos



Approximate Taper Location and U-Turn direction

Contributing Factors

- There is no work instruction on how to complete Pilot Vehicle operations.
- There is no training on how to complete Pilot Vehicle operations.
- There was no inspection of the turnaround sites to determine if the turning area was suitable or if a different authorised turning area was required.
- Positive Communication between all TC's was not in use.
- TC's completed an "add on" and the "add on" was not condemned by the Team Leader.

Corrective Actions

- Update and release for use SWMS that covers Pilot Vehicle Operations.
- Communicate with all staff that U-Turns are only permitted at designated turning areas or under the supervision/direction of a suitably qualified TC.
- Risk assess and create a Pilot Vehicle Operation procedure which is then issued for use.
- Communicate with all staff that the act of "Adding On" is to cease.
- Carry out positive communications training with all staff. Positive Communications training is to include getting a suitable response from the responder that they have understood your information.

Additional Issues / Learnings

- Main Roads have highlighted previous incidents involving turn around points or U-Turns, however the contractor had not learnt from these incidents.
- Positive Communication is spoken about in just about every pre-start meeting, however, limited workers know how to implement it correctly. Correct "call and respond" processes are rarely used by TC's.
- Worker's actions showed that positive communications are not seen as a critical control as workers took risks rather than force positive communications to occur.
- Workers doing the same duties for many continuous days lose focus of hazards and potential risks. Task rotation has many more benefits than just fatigue management.

**Critical Risk:**

This serious potential incident aligns with the Main Roads Critical Risk Profile relating to
Vehicles and Driving

Distribution of Notice

Main Roads Personnel and Contracting Organisations